

SWORD·WEAVE

PLAYER'S HANDBOOK

Imagine a person. Give them rules. Play a shared story.



MARIUS ION / v0.1 alpha / 11 OCTOBER 2026

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swordweave.quest/books / Dark digital edition

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Read, make, play

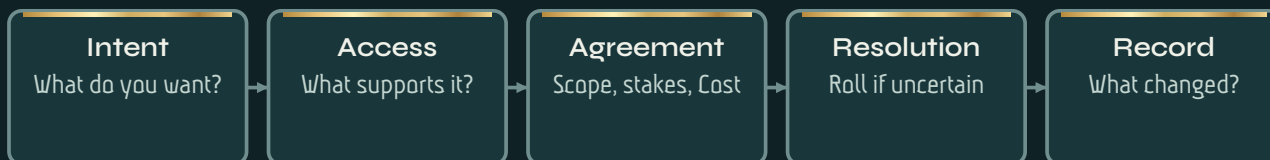
SwordWeave is a construction-led tabletop roleplaying game. You invent a person, acquire understandable permissions and rules, and propose what they do in a world shared with friends. You do not need to choose a fixed class or buy a finished heritage to begin.

This book is the player-facing teaching guide. Read *Begin* a shared story and *Make* someone you want to play first. Then follow the *play* chapters as questions arise. The primitive reference and complete worked records provide the definitions you need offline. The free *Game Master's Guide* helps the person running the world; the *System Reference Document* states the same framework for lookup and reuse.

You need: people to play with, character records, a way to take notes, and dice or a roller capable of d20 and your actual output dice. The website is useful but not required. Agree the setting, character budget, equipment and expectations with your table.

Edition: v0.1 alpha. One numerical upkeep rule remains explicitly pending; its notice appears in the upkeep chapter. The rest of this book presents the current agreed framework. Examples illustrate their stated situations, not universal spell prices.

From an idea to a changed scene



Agree access, scope and stakes before commitment. A player may revise the attempt; the recorded result becomes the next situation.

BEGIN a SHARED STORY

SwordWeave is a tabletop roleplaying game. Each player portrays a character: someone with a place in the world, things they can do and something they want. The Dungeon Master, also called the Game Master, describes the surroundings and portrays the other people and creatures you meet. Your choices and their consequences create the adventure together.

You can play around a table or meet online. Bring a character sheet, a way to roll dice and a way to record changes. The website can help build and track a character, but you can also play with a printed sheet and notes.

AGREE WHAT YOU ARE PLAYING

Before making characters, talk about the adventure. Are you explorers trying to reach a lost city, troublesome apprentices, people defending their home, or something else? Agree what kinds of situations you want to explore and which subjects should stay outside the game. Anyone can ask to pause or change an uncomfortable scene.

Ask the DM which starting level or Build Unit budget to use, which existing creations fit the setting and whether equipment has a separate allowance. A simple beginning helps a new group learn; a higher starting budget gives a more developed character. The table chooses the starting point together.

DESCRIBE WHAT YOU WANT TO ACCOMPLISH

The DM presents a situation. Describe your character's intent in ordinary words. You can ask what they see, hear or already know before committing to an attempt.

Example

DM: "Smoke rises through the stairwell. From upstairs, you hear someone coughing. The staircase is beginning to collapse."

Mira: "Where are the windows? Is there water nearby? I want to make a way for them to get out."

An intent gives the conversation direction. You do not need a saved ability whose title describes the exact situation. Ordinary actions depend on the circumstances and your character's competence. Extraordinary workings use the permissions your character owns.

A **primitive** is a reusable rule or permission. A water-shaping character might own a domain permission for Water and a verb permission for changing its form. Those ingredients can support several ideas: draw water along a ledge, shape a barrier or redirect a stream. Each attempt still needs a workable scope and an agreed resolution.

GIVE EXCITING IDEAS A CHANCE

Core rule — the Rule of Cool. Give an exciting idea a fair hearing. Talk through what makes it possible, what it risks and how it will resolve. The rules help everyone understand the attempt and its consequences.

The table can agree an unusual application or exception when it makes the scene coherent and engaging. State that agreement clearly. Being able to reach a window through a collapsing roof can depend on the route, timing and danger, even if a similar jump was easy elsewhere.

Mira's group might decide that a rushing channel of water can support a brief rescue. Holding it open could restrict her other workings, require continuous attention or leave her unable to shape water for a while afterward. The cost can be mechanical, narrative or both. Vitality damage is one possible consequence among many.

AGREE THE ATTEMPT BEFORE ROLLING

Work through these questions together:

1. **What is the intended result?** Name what you are trying to change or achieve.
2. **What makes it possible?** Check ordinary circumstances and any required permissions.
3. **What is the actual scope?** Describe the target, reach, output, timing and persistence.
4. **What is at stake?** Agree the difficulty, cost and relevant consequences, including what failure can mean.
5. **How will it resolve?** Decide whether it happens directly, needs a check or needs another suitable procedure.

You may accept those terms, narrow the attempt, spend more time or try another approach. Useful questions can prevent an unnecessary roll or reveal a better plan.

Example

Mira: "I want to pull water from the trough into a passage leading to the upstairs window."

DM: "Your Water and verb permissions support shaping the channel. Make it narrow enough for one person, and you can hold it while Sol helps them across. You will need to keep directing it; if you stop, it falls apart."

Mira: "Could I leave it standing and go inside?"

DM: "That is a different working. We can discuss a lasting structure, or you can keep this version small and maintained."

Neither working needs to match a catalogue title. Their differences affect access, effort and consequences.

READ A DIE ROLL

Dice answer uncertain questions. A **d20** is a twenty-sided die. **1d4** means one four-sided die; **4d10** means roll four ten-sided dice and add their results.

For an ordinary check, roll a d20 and add the relevant bonus. A **DC**, or Difficulty Class, is the number the total must meet or beat. The DM chooses a suitable check and establishes what the result means. Straightforward, uncontested actions may happen without a roll.

Your check generally includes the relevant current attribute, training where it applies and other applicable modifiers. The sheet can display their combined bonus. Add that displayed total once.

Example

The DM asks Sol to cross an unstable ledge with a displayed bonus of +5 against DC 12. Sol rolls 9. The total is 14, so the attempt succeeds under the agreed terms.

Sol does not add another proficiency bonus already included in that +5.

Default — advantage and disadvantage. Applicable sources stack according to their authored rules. Cancel opposing stacks one-for-one. Each remaining stack adds one resolution die: with two advantages, roll three dice and keep the highest; with two disadvantages, keep the lowest. If they cancel completely, roll one die. A particular primitive may state different stacking behavior.

CARRY THE RESULT FORWARD

Apply the agreed outcome and describe the changed scene. Spend resources, change current Vitality or record a consequence when needed. A consequence should say what it does and what ends it. “Exhausted voice: cannot maintain sung workings until recovered” tells the table more than an unexplained condition name.

Other characters act from that new situation. In combat, the group coordinates a shared round through **Council, Fast, Measured and Heavy**. The combat chapter explains that rhythm; ordinary conversation and exploration do not need to be forced into a combat round.

RECOGNIZE THE KINDS OF GUIDANCE

Throughout this handbook, **Core rule** identifies the shared framework, and **Default** identifies the supplied procedure. **Authored rule** belongs to a particular primitive, item or working. **Optional guidance** offers a treatment your table can choose. An **Example** illustrates one situation, and an **App note** explains a digital control.

Tables can agree variations. Keep the actual agreement clear, especially when someone is learning the game or joining an established group.

Make someone you want to play

BEGIN WITH A PERSON AND A PURPOSE

Write a short concept: who the character is, something they can do and what draws them into the adventure. Their history can grow through play.

Mira is a curious courier who learned to shape water while travelling with a river caravan. Her teacher has disappeared. She wants to find them and keeps getting distracted by people who need help.

That concept suggests useful permissions and a reason to act. It does not require a fixed class or a prescribed sequence of abilities.

CHOOSE THE FOUNDATION

Your three attributes are **Physical**, **Mental** and **Magical**. Physical describes bodily approaches; Mental describes perception, thought and interaction; Magical describes extraordinary understanding and expression. Their numerical values are used directly in relevant checks and formulas.

Default — starting attributes. Allocate a total of 10 among the three base attributes, with each from -1 to +5. Later primitives can change the resulting values. Keep the base allocation distinct from those contributions.

A proficient attribute supports its associated practices and saves. Particular practice training can also be acquired through authored rules. Your choices should fit the concept; the foundation does not impose a class.

The ten practices are:

Attribute	Practices
Physical	Prowess, Finesse, Fieldcraft
Mental	Awareness, Reason, Knowledge, Influence
Magical	Mysticism, Communion, Intuition

You can attempt ordinary tasks without training. Training adds the applicable Proficiency Bonus; it is not permission to try the task at all. Relevant extraordinary permissions still matter.

BUY USEFUL PERMISSIONS

Build Units, abbreviated **BU**, are the purchase budget for reusable primitives. A default level 1 foundation has 25 BU. Agree a different starting level or budget with the DM when appropriate.

A character foundation needs owned verb and domain access in its character build. A **verb tier** establishes the kind of change you can attempt; a **domain** establishes the subject you can work with. Read their actual definitions. Equipment cannot substitute for those foundation requirements.

When the corresponding categories are absent, Touch range and Id4 output are free baselines. Further reach and different output dice can be acquired through suitable primitives. Larger output, several targets or unusual selectivity can still change an attempt's pressure and cost.

Prices in the Library and builder are suggestions and authored choices. You may invent a primitive, choose a price and discuss it with the DM. Conditions, limits and stacking can justify different prices. The DM can accept the proposal or ask you to adjust it before using it at their table.

Example — Mira's purchases

Mira's player chooses base attributes Physical 3, Mental 3 and Magical 4, with Magical as the proficient attribute. The player then builds this ledger using the current canonical entries:

| Primitive | BU |

| --- | ---: |

| Verb Access Tier II | 8 |

| Water through Domain Access Tier I | 4 |

| Near Range | 4 |

| d8 output permission | 4 |

| Knowledge proficiency | 4 |

| **Total purchased** | **24** |

| **Unspent from 25** | **1** |

The scope of the Water domain and verb permission still governs her workings. Near reaches up to 30 ft. Owning d8 permits that die type; the chosen number of dice and the particular result are discussed when she describes an action.

Mira's level I Proficiency Bonus is 2. Her trained Knowledge bonus is Mental 3 plus PB 2, for +5. If Magical is selected for her DC, the baseline is $5 + \text{PB } 2 + \text{Magical } 4 = 11$. Her baseline maximum Vitality is $(10 + \text{PB } 2) \times \text{level I} = 12$, before relevant modifiers.

This ledger teaches the accounting. Your character's prices and rules need the same table agreement.

ORGANIZE YOUR HISTORY AND ABILITIES

Lineage describes ancestry or species. **Upbringing** describes background and training. **Manifest** describes a role or current expression of the character. These heritages can organize primitives into a coherent foundation.

You can develop your own heritages, adapt an existing one or use several where the concept and table agreement support them. A heritage name alone grants no additional mechanics. Check the actual ingredients and count purchases appropriately.

An **effect** groups related outcomes or ingredients. A **capability** organizes a complete working or ready intent. Once you own its ingredients, describing another arrangement does not buy the same primitives again. A new arrangement still needs suitable permissions, scope and resolution.

KEEP ITEMS SEPARATE

Items have their own **Item BU** accounting. Agree an equipment allowance with the DM rather than assuming it is included in the character's 25 BU.

Default — equipped slots. You have six universal equipment slots. An ordinary equipped item uses one; a two-handed item uses two. A particular item can have a higher agreed requirement, and primitives can extend your available slots. Size does not automatically multiply that requirement.

A small courier might be allowed to wield an unusually large sword with a three-slot requirement or another consequence. Describe the adjustment on that item so everyone knows how to apply it.

Load tracks what you carry and remains separate from equipped slots and Item BU. An unequipped item can still contribute Load.

CHECK THAT THE CHARACTER IS READY

Before the first scene, make sure you can explain:

- Your character's purpose and how they connect to the party.
- Their base attributes, training and current check bonuses.
- The purchased verb and domain permissions that support their special actions.
- Purchased BU, unspent BU and separate equipment accounting.
- Current and maximum Vitality, equipped gear and any actual drawbacks.

Drawbacks are optional. Accept their real consequences before using any permitted mirror credit; a descriptive personality flaw does not automatically produce BU. Detailed mirroring and progression rules appear in the budget chapter.

App note. Quickbuild and complete creation both produce characters you can keep developing. A form may offer one slot for each heritage type as a convenience. That form does not replace the table's agreement about the character's concept.

Read and compose your abilities

You have a concept and a purchase ledger. Now turn those ingredients into things you can explain and use. You can use something from the Library, adapt it or build your own. All three approaches use the same construction rules.

Start with the intended result

Describe what you want in ordinary words before choosing a name or mechanical format. “Guide water from one vessel into another” gives the table something to judge. A title such as River Hand helps you find the working again, but its description and ingredients establish what it does.

Ask which parts of the result need extraordinary access. Moving an ordinary bucket can be an ordinary action. Shaping its contents from across a room requires the relevant permissions. A primitive can grant a permission, change a number or establish a particular rule; read its definition rather than relying on its icon or family name.

Read the main building blocks

The Market organizes base primitives into families. Begin with the following questions:

Question	Relevant foundations
What kind of change can I make?	Verb access
What can I work with?	Domain access
How is the working arranged or delivered?	Structure and targeting
How far does it reach?	Range
What output can I express?	Intensity and dice
How does it persist or respond?	Duration, triggers and particular authored rules
What changes on my sheet?	Attribute/practice grants, numerical modifiers, senses, mobility, defenses and other augmentations

These questions are a way to read a working, not a requirement to purchase one primitive from every family. Use your baselines and owned rules, then identify any additional permission the proposed result actually needs.

Default reference — access tiers. The base verb, domain and structure families use four access tiers with suggested anchors of 4, 8, 12 and 16 BU. Their meanings differ by family. Verb Tier II describes changing existing states; Domain Tier II describes a different breadth of subjects. Owning one does not grant the other.

Range and output use their own ladders. Near Range permits 30 ft with a current suggested cost of 4 BU. The d8 output permission also has a current suggested cost of 4 BU, but it grants a die type, not distance. A shared price does not make two primitives interchangeable. The reference tables collect these base definitions; authors and the table can agree different prices for their actual rules.



Lines are references to owned acquisitions. A primitive can be used directly or through several containers; appearances do not create extra purchases.

MAKE AN EFFECT, THEN A CAPABILITY WHEN USEFUL

An **effect** groups related ingredients or outcomes so you can reuse them. A **capability** organizes a working, talent or ready intent. A capability can contain primitives directly and can also use effects. An effect need not be created as a separate card before every capability.

For each construction, record:

1. Its name and intended result.
2. The ingredients and what each contributes.
3. The recipient or target, scope and applicable conditions.
4. Any numerical change, output, trigger or duration it actually establishes.
5. Stacking, limits and ending conditions where they matter.
6. How it is proposed and resolved in play, including any agreed continuation requirement.

Keep a permanent acquired rule distinct from the temporary result of using it. Owning a water-shaping permission does not mean every water structure is permanent. Owning a die type does not automatically heal every injured target or establish resistance to incoming damage.

Worked construction — River Hand

Mira's player uses her Water domain and Verb Access Tier II to describe guiding and reshaping existing water. Near Range supports attempts up to 30 ft where she can locate the target. They organize these ingredients as an effect called Guided Water, then use it in a capability called River Hand.

The capability says what Mira can propose: redirect a stream or guide water between vessels within her access and reach. It does not promise that every quantity, route or situation succeeds without a check. At the table, they establish the actual volume, obstacles, timing and consequences.

Her d8 permission remains available for an appropriate damage or healing working; simply including it in a ledger does not turn moving water into an automatic attack or cure. She may compose another capability when she wants such a result.

KEEP ONE PURCHASE LEDGER

Organizing the same acquired ingredient in several effects, capabilities or heritages does not repurchase it. Count the underlying acquisitions, including any deliberately acquired additional occurrences. Read each rule's restrictions before deciding that several appearances create several contributions.

Mira already owns all five purchases in her 24-BU ledger. Guided Water and River Hand organize some of those ingredients; they do not increase her total to 48 BU or produce extra free copies of the rules. If she later acquires a new ingredient, record that acquisition and its cost.

BUILD A HERITAGE AROUND THE PERSON

A heritage connects mechanics to ancestry, experience or current expression. Choose **Lineage**, **Upbringing** or **Manifest** according to what the creation represents. Include the rules and capabilities that support its description, and identify the actual acquisitions it contains.

Worked construction — River Caravan Upbringing

Mira's player groups Verb Access Tier II (8 BU), Water domain access (4 BU) and Knowledge proficiency (4 BU) into an upbringing inspired by her training: **16 BU** of acquired primitives. Near Range and d8 output remain other purchases: **4 + 4 BU**. The whole character still costs **24 BU**, leaving **1** from her 25-BU budget.

Another river-caravan character can choose different training and permissions. The heritage name does not make every member a water shaper or grant unlisted abilities.

You can adapt this upbringing or write a new one. A compelling biography can remain descriptive; mechanical benefits need their actual rules. Likewise, a descriptive flaw becomes a purchased drawback only through its agreed mechanical or narrative terms and the applicable mirror rules.

WRITE A NEW PRIMITIVE WHEN YOUR IDEA NEEDS ONE

First state the rule in readable language. Identify who receives it, what it permits or changes, when it applies, how it stacks and any limit. Propose a BU price and explain the scope or restrictions behind it. Review it with the DM before relying on it in a build.

A useful review asks whether two readers would apply the rule the same way. “See heat” needs a scope: what sense is granted, what it can distinguish, what blocks it and whether it locates a target well enough for a working. “Gain a bonus while wet” needs the affected check or metric, the amount, the meaning of wet and its stacking treatment.

You do not need a catalogue entry whose name exactly matches your concept. The base families provide vocabulary and examples for authoring. Their suggested prices help the conversation; the author and table settle the actual rule and price.

AGREE CONSEQUENCES AS PART OF THE WORKING

Consequences are part of play and can also be part of an authored rule. They can change numbers, restrict an action, consume a resource, affect the surroundings or create a narrative obligation. The same condition name can describe different consequences in different situations.

Before committing, agree what the consequence means and when it applies. A clear record includes:

Detail	Example of an agreed consequence
Source and affected subject	Mira maintains a difficult water channel.
Actual change	She must keep directing it and cannot use this same working for a second channel at the same time.
When it applies	While she continues maintaining this channel.
How it ends	Ending the working releases the restriction and the unsupported water falls away.
Recovery or follow-up	If the attempt causes another lasting consequence, record its own ending or recovery terms.

This is an example agreement, not a universal limit of one channel or one maintained capability. Other circumstances can support another scope, cost or continuation requirement.

If the agreed cost is Vitality, record the amount and timing. If it is lost access until a task is completed, record that task. A new round or rest does not erase a consequence whose stated ending has not occurred. Agree lasting injuries and other special recovery needs explicitly.

An attempt can have a small or negligible cost when the situation supports it. Ambition, urgency and danger affect the appraisal. **BU buys reusable mechanics; execution has its own agreed**

consequences. Do not spend BU every time you use a purchased primitive unless a particular agreed rule establishes a different purchase or consumption arrangement.

TRY THE CONSTRUCTION IN A SCENE

Test more than its most favorable use. Ask what happens when the target is hidden, the proposed result is larger, the actor is interrupted or two rules contribute at once. Clarify missing terms before the construction becomes hard to apply during a tense scene.

Mira can guide nearby water in a calm room without assuming the same outcome for a flooded, collapsing stairwell. The latter adds moving obstacles, frightened people and urgency. Her access remains the foundation; the table appraises this attempt and agrees its resolution.

App note. The Library provides examples and the Atelier helps organize and inspect creations. Keep the actual ingredient definitions with an offline character record. A saved card is convenient, but the table's agreed rules and the character's acquisitions determine what is available.

RESOLVE uncertainty

You do not roll because you named a practice. You roll when the result is uncertain and the difference matters. Explain how you approach the problem. The DM and players establish the relevant attribute or practice, the opposition or DC, and what the possible outcomes mean.

Default check: roll d20 + the relevant current attribute + applicable training + applicable modifiers. Meet or beat the agreed DC. Use the attribute's actual value; Physical 3 contributes +3, not a converted score modifier.

If your sheet already shows a combined practice bonus, add that bonus once. Mira's trained Knowledge is Mental 3 + PB 2 = +5. A roll of 9 gives 14. Against DC 12, that succeeds. Adding Mental and PB again would incorrectly give 19.

TEN PRACTICES, MANY APPROACHES

Attribute	Practice	Ways it might matter
Physical	Prowess	Force, exertion or holding a contested position.
Physical	Finesse	Precise movement, careful manipulation or concealment through movement.
Physical	Fieldcraft	Practical survival, handling hazards or stabilizing an injured companion.
Mental	Awareness	Noticing relevant details or following a visible development.
Mental	Reason	Analysis, deduction or understanding a mechanism.
Mental	Knowledge	Recalling learned information or applying a familiar discipline.
Mental	Influence	Persuading, negotiating or expressing a credible threat.
Magical	Mysticism	Understanding or applying extraordinary workings.
Magical	Communion	Relating to or communicating through an appropriate extraordinary connection.
Magical	Intuition	Interpreting an extraordinary impression or choosing through granted insight.

These are examples of approaches, not exhaustive permission lists. Ordinary attempts remain available without training. Extraordinary results require their actual access. A social check does not automatically give control over another character's decisions.

Default. Proficiency adds PB where applicable. Expertise uses twice PB when granted. A repeated grant of the same training does not itself add another PB. A separate explicit numerical bonus follows its own conditions and stacking rules.

PB starts at 2. Its baseline is $2 + \text{floor}((\text{level} - 1) / 4)$, before active modifiers. The explicit floor is part of this formula; the ordinary rounding rule elsewhere is upward.

Attacks, Saves and Your DC

Default attack. Roll d20 + the relevant current attribute + applicable PB training + attack modifiers against the target's DC. Meet or beat it to hit, then resolve the actual damage or effect separately. A miss does not deal the hit's damage unless a specific rule says otherwise. Use the displayed combined attack bonus once.

Default save. A recipient resisting a save-based capability rolls d20 + the relevant current attribute + applicable saving-throw training + save modifiers against the user's DC. The actual capability/source determines the appropriate Physical, Mental or Magical save and the outcome of success/failure. The chosen proficient attribute grants PB to its own saving throw; other saves do not gain that PB automatically. An additional training grant can establish it at its stated scope.

Example. An attack roll of 11 with +6 gives 17 against DC 15: it hits. If the chosen construction instead calls for a save, the recipient rolls that save against the user's DC; it is not a second automatic roll after the hit.

An attack tests whether an attempted attack succeeds. A saving throw tests an actor's resistance to an effect. Your working's actual delivery and the table's resolution determine which is appropriate; using a capability does not demand both an attack and a saving throw by default.

Default. Your selected-attribute DC is $5 + \text{current PB} + \text{the chosen eligible current modified attribute} + \text{direct DC modifiers}$. Mira's Magical 4 and PB 2 give DC 11. Physical, Mental and Magical saving throws remain separate values. They do not imply three different character DCs. Use the relevant save and its actual granted training or modifiers.

Read authored result floors, ceilings and fixed-result rules at their stated scope. A minimum check result does not raise the attribute itself. An attribute increase can instead affect every derived number based on it. Do not add an automatic natural-20 success, natural-1 failure or critical-damage multiplier unless the table or an authored rule has established one.

Advantage can stack

Default. Apply the sources' conditions and uniqueness rules, then cancel advantage and disadvantage one-for-one. Each remaining stack adds one resolution die. Roll $N + 1$ dice for N net stacks: keep the highest for advantage and the lowest for disadvantage. With none remaining, roll one die. Add the applicable static bonus once after selecting the die.

Examples. Two advantages and one disadvantage leave one advantage: roll 2d20, highest. Two advantages without opposition give 3d20, highest. Two disadvantages give 3d20, lowest. Stacking does not bypass a primitive that expressly forbids repeated contributions.

ACT TOGETHER IN COMBAT

one shared round, coordinated together



Complexity places dependencies in the rhythm. Movement is one round allowance; a valid reaction pauses a moment without creating a new personal turn.

A combat round is a shared problem. Your party can coordinate a plan, resolve simpler actions before dependent ones and respond when the situation changes. SwordWeave uses **Council then Fast then Measured then Heavy**. There is no default initiative roll or imported bonus-action sequence.

COUNCIL: MAKE THE PLAN UNDERSTANDABLE

Describe one coherent Main Intent. Coordinate with your allies and establish which actions depend on another result. The DM describes what the opposition is visibly attempting. Check access, timing, scope and stakes before commitment.

Default tracks: Fast resolves Complexity 0-1; Measured resolves 2-3; Heavy resolves 4+. Complexity concerns timing dependencies, not a ranking of damage or power. A straightforward powerful strike need not become Heavy merely because it has large output. Agree a rushed or altered timing with its actual access and consequences.

Track where the round leaves everyone. When a path collapses in Fast, an action planned for Heavy must use the changed route rather than an imaginary unchanged battlefield.

CLASHES AND CONTESTS

Use a **Reaction Clash** when opposing intents meet within a track and arriving first matters. Roll d20 + relevant attribute + PB if trained, with applicable rules. The higher result acts first. On a tie, the GM resolves simultaneously or follows the stronger fictional position.

Use an **Active Contest** when efforts directly oppose: holding a door against someone forcing it open, or slipping past a watchful opponent. Agree a suitable approach for each side. Use the relevant combined practice bonus once where a practice applies. The higher result wins the immediate struggle.

Losing timing does not automatically erase your Main Intent. If a guard rings a bell before you seize their arm, the alarm has sounded; seizing the arm may still be possible. If your plan has become impossible, pivot: redirect it, reduce the scope or accept another sensible consequence before resolution.

one independent reaction

Default. You have one Reaction Slot each round, reset at Council. A reaction needs a clear event you can perceive and an available response you can perform. Its default scope is immediate, Complexity 0-I, and self/touch or one target. Relevant access and position still matter. A larger response needs a specific permission or explicit table ruling.

Pause the triggering event, resolve the reaction, then continue. A reaction can occur before or after your Main Intent. It does not automatically cancel the event it responds to.

Example. Neri catches an ally slipping beside them. Being nearby and able to catch them establishes the opportunity. Saving everyone falling across a distant broken bridge is a different scope; spending a Reaction Slot alone does not grant that rescue.

move across the round

Default. Your Speed is movement available across the whole round. Spend some or all, divide it among tracks or valid reactions, and include it in an intent or move independently where the situation permits. Beginning a later track or using a reaction does not give a fresh allowance.

Example. Speed 30 ft supports moving 10 ft in Fast and 20 ft in Heavy. Moving farther needs an appropriate speed primitive or an agreed Cost/consequence. Actual routes, interference and hazards still apply; reach is not permission to pass through a wall.

Size	Walking Speed	Default swimming/climbing
Tiny	15 ft	8 ft
Small	25 ft	13 ft
Medium	30 ft	15 ft
Large	40 ft	20 ft
Huge	60 ft	30 ft
Gargantuan	90 ft	45 ft

Swimming/climbing default to half base speed rounded up. Authored rules can change these values. Flight and burrowing require their relevant grants.

A BRIDGE ROUND

Example. Mira will restrain a guard's alarm arm; Sol will build a supported path across a gap; Neri will move an injured friend once the path exists. At Council they agree access, movement, timing and what failure risks. The guard reaches for the bell while another opponent attacks the support.

In Fast, Mira clashes with the guard. Suppose the guard wins timing: the bell rings, and Mira can still try to restrain them if possible. Damage to the support changes Sol's construction. In Measured, Sol completes a smaller path at the agreed continuing cost. Neri uses that path in the agreed order. A nearby slip can create a valid reaction opportunity; a more elaborate dependent attempt resolves in Heavy.

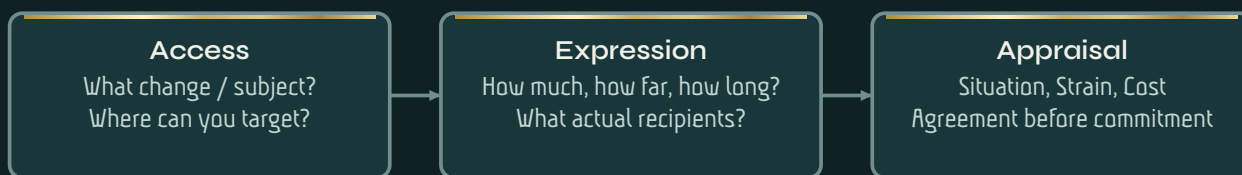
Before the next Council, record damage, costs, current positions, continuing requirements and unresolved consequences. The party crossed, but pursuers now know where to look. Success at the crossing did not erase the alarm.

Optional guidance: surprise. There is no universal surprise subsystem. A table might let prepared enemies complete a round before surprised participants respond. The circumstances or an agreed d20 check may change that treatment. An ambush does not automatically entitle every enemy to a free round.

PUSH THE LIMITS

Owned access establishes what you can propose. The particular attempt establishes how much pressure it creates. d10 output and Very Far reach do not make four dice against a distant crowd as effortless as one die at Touch range. Describe the chosen output, recipients, area, distance, duration and timing; the table appraises the whole result.

PERMISSION, EXPRESSION AND CONSEQUENCE



Increasing effort can scale an eligible use. It does not supply a missing verb, domain, behavior or sensory location.

SCALE, IMPACT AND COMPLEXITY

Scale asks how much is affected. Impact asks how strongly the result changes it. Complexity asks how the working's parts depend on each other. Environment, opposition, available support and urgency matter too.

Raising dice count, area, targets or duration does not require a separate acquisition for every dial by default. It can increase Strain and Cost. Adding a new behavior, such as healing allies inside an enemy-harming blast, may require additional access and a different construction. Neither a bigger die nor a higher payment silently grants the behavior.

Core rule. Locate a specific target through a relevant sense. Vision, granted blindsight, tremorsense or another suitable method can establish its location. Range alone does not reveal it. Without that location, propose targeting a known spot or area and resolve uncertainty; the desired creature might not be there.

An authored working can establish another targeting method, including scrying, broad weather control or any qualifying target within a stated range. Agree its actual scope and exceptions. Extreme reach can extend by DM agreement, but extra distance does not supply knowledge of the target.

AGREE A COST BEFORE COMMITTING

Strain is a 0–6 appraisal guide, from effortless through light effort, noticeable strain, heavy burden, dangerous instability, critical risk and catastrophic consequence. A grade is not an automatic Vitality bill or a fixed chance of success.

Cost can be Vitality, a resource, a numerical penalty, exposure, a restriction, environmental change or a narrative consequence. It may be negligible. Agree what applies, when it applies and what failure means. Interruption has no universal refund rule.

Example. Heating a wet lock can scorch a tool or exhaust the actor. Setting a roof ablaze can spread fire into neighboring homes. Smaller scope, help or more time can change the proposed stakes. Ask for those alternatives before accepting a cost you did not intend.

Optional guidance: CV. A table can compare evaluated construction values. If minimum composition value B is 12 and the selected use A is 30, the scaling increase is $A - B = 18$; total CV is 30. These illustrate arithmetic, not a universal spell price. CV is not added to a roll and is not acquisition BU paid again. Numerical comparison supports appraisal; it does not capture every difference in environment or behavior.

KEEP A WORKING ALIVE

When a working resolves, how long its result lasts, and what sustains it are three separate questions. Track answers the first, duration the second, upkeep the third. A fixed duration does not automatically require active maintenance.

Example. A flame can flash and end, remain for two rounds without further effort, or last while the actor sustains it. Write which construction applies. Continuing a working can spread its pressure over time; there is no compulsory numerical discount from doing so.

ONGOING CONSEQUENCES

Agree the maintenance requirement, its payment point within the shared rhythm and what happens if it cannot be met. Council is a useful agreed continuation point. A 4-Vitality requirement paid this round can be due again next round while the working continues. A loss of access until a task is completed instead lasts according to that ending condition. New rounds do not silently remove it.

Default. One maintained capability has one execution, one Strain appraisal and one upkeep track, even if it contains multiple effects. You may maintain several capabilities; their actual requirements accumulate. There is no default single-concentration limit.

A hit does not universally stop a working. Singing continuously may be threatened by silence. Burning incense may be threatened by losing the incense. An unconscious actor cannot continue a task they can no longer perform. Determine interference from the actual requirement, position, timing and consequence.

Alpha rule pending — damage-triggered Vitality upkeep. The creator has deferred the additional repayment threshold and damage-counter/reset/excess policy. This edition does not impose that scheme. Agree any temporary table treatment explicitly; ordinary continuation requirements remain usable. This notice does not alter upkeep paid through other mechanical, restrictive or narrative consequences.

INTERFERE WITH UNFINISHED WORK

Describe a real way to interfere and establish the opportunity before the action resolves. Reach the actor, break an essential support, disrupt a required circle or use a suitable countering working. A reaction also needs its available slot and valid scope. Resolve the relevant attack, save, clash or contest; apply the agreed failure, partial result or continued execution.

Example. A gate needs an intact chalk circle. Scattering it before completion can threaten the actual construction. Missing the attempt does not stop the gate. Hitting its maker need not stop it if no agreed requirement is disrupted. Once an instant flash has resolved, its execution can no longer be interrupted retroactively; a resulting ongoing effect may still be disrupted through relevant access.

SURVIVE AND CARRY CONSEQUENCES

Vitality measures health, stamina and exertion. There is no universal separate mana pool or spell-slot track.

Player baseline maximum Vitality is $(10 + \text{current PB}) \times \text{level}$, then active maximum-Vitality rules. Current Vitality is a separate value; raising the maximum does not itself grant healing.

DAMAGE HAS A SOURCE AND DOMAIN

Physical, Magical and Psychic describe execution sources; fire, cold or another domain describes identity. Mental is an attribute, not an interchangeable name for Psychic source. Read the actual defense's source/domain scope.

Default. Resistance halves covered damage, rounded up; vulnerability doubles it; immunity negates damage within its stated scope. Multiple resistances do not quarter damage by default. Applicable resistance and vulnerability on the same instance cancel. Damage immunity does not automatically negate every associated consequence.

Example. Nine Magical Fire damage becomes 5 with matching resistance, 18 with matching vulnerability, or 9 when both apply. A mixed execution dealing 6 Physical Fire and 8 Magical Fire loses only 4 from its Magical portion under Magical-only resistance: total loss is 10. Establish whether mixed domains split one output or produce separate instances before applying defenses.

Apply the final damage as Vitality loss. Healing restores Vitality within the current maximum. **App note.** Manual damage fields do not automatically apply typed defenses; resolve them first.

COLLAPSE IS A RESCUE PROBLEM

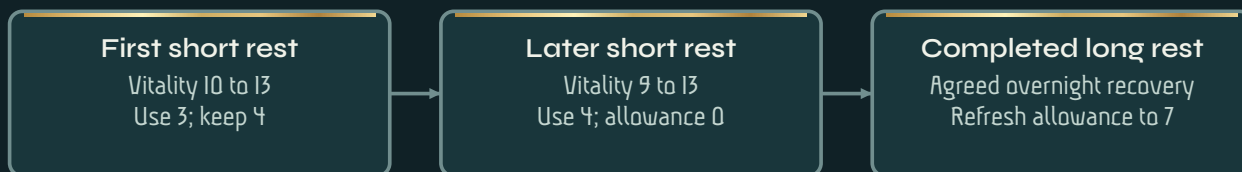
Default. At zero Vitality, collapse leaves the character unconscious and incapacitated. The GM establishes contextual rescue stakes. Roughly a minute is guidance, not ten guaranteed safe rounds. Severe wounds or a hostile environment can shorten the opportunity.

Allies can dedicate an action track to Fieldcraft stabilization or a suitable creative use of owned primitives. The table agrees access, resolution and Cost; there is no universal stabilization DC. Successful stabilization halts the rescue countdown. It does not itself restore Vitality or wake the character. Healing above zero ends the dying state and restores consciousness unless another consequence prevents it. A stabilized character can recover through assisted rest; an actively dying character needs rescue first.

Massive damage. A single execution dealing at least twice maximum Vitality, or taking current Vitality to -maximum Vitality, can cause immediate death under the massive-damage rule. Establish lethal stakes before resolution. Use final damage after defenses and the current value before the hit; a sheet storing zero must not hide the overrun.

Example. Maximum 13, current 4 and final damage 17 gives $4 - 17 = -13$. This reaches the negative-maximum boundary even though the blow is below 26. A blow of 26 reaches twice maximum independently. The contextual collapse rescue clock does not reverse an outright lethal result.

UNUSED SHORT-REST RECOVERY CARRIES FORWARD



Maximum 13: the allowance is $\text{ceil}(13/2) = 7$. Consume only actual healing; a completed long rest refreshes the allowance.

RECOVERY IS AGREED, NOT AUTOMATIC

A short rest is a pause, perhaps 15 or 30 minutes. A long rest is overnight sleep or an equivalent meaningful recovery period, not a mandatory eight-hour timer. DM and players agree whether the circumstances earn either rest's effects. Elapsed time alone does not apply them.

Default. Short rests share a finite allowance of half maximum Vitality rounded up between completed long rests. Only actual points restored consume it. Retain unused points for later agreed short rests. A completed long rest normally restores Vitality to maximum and refreshes that allowance; its healing is not charged against the short-rest pool.

Example: maximum 13	Actual recovery	Short-rest allowance left
Begin after a long rest	—	$\text{ceil}(13 / 2) = 7$
At 10/13, agree a short rest	3, reaching 13/13	4
Later at 9/13, agree another short rest	4, reaching 13/13	0
Complete the next long rest	Normal full recovery	7, refreshed

The DM can adjust recovery by agreement. After poor sleep the table might allow 70% rather than full restoration; apply ordinary upward rounding when the chosen calculation needs it. A completed long rest still refreshes the short-rest allowance. Record the agreed amount rather than quietly assuming every rest is equally restorative.

Injuries, curses, access restrictions and other lasting consequences keep their own recovery requirements. Healing a burned character's Vitality does not automatically repair the destroyed map, remove a specific injury or satisfy an obligation. State what remains and how it can change.

EQUIPMENT AND GROWTH

An item can be an ordinary tool, a carrier for capabilities or a source of active modifications. Record what it actually provides, what must be equipped, its Item BU, Load and slot requirement. Describing a sword as enormous does not by itself write all those rules.

Default. You have six universal equipment slots. An ordinary equipped item uses one, a two-handed item uses two. A primitive can extend your slots. An agreed unusual item may require more or impose another consequence: a small character using an oversized sword might accept a 3–4-slot requirement. Size alone is not an automatic slot multiplier.

Load measures carrying; slots measure use. Equipped items still contribute Load. Capacity is size base + 5 × current Physical + applicable capacity bonuses. Load above capacity is encumbered; agree the resulting penalties or complications.

Size	Base capacity	Ordinary Load per item
Tiny	10	Pouch rule
Small	20	1
Medium	40	2
Large	80	4
Huge	160	8
Gargantuan	320	16

One pouch holds up to 1,000 tiny items and contributes 1 Load. A backpack organizes contents; changing capacity requires an actual rule. Use an item's explicit Load rule where granted. Keep purchase price or treasure value separate from Item BU and Load.

HOW AN ATTACK REACHES A TARGET

Projected vectors travel through space: arrows, beams or thrown blasts. Minor obstruction imposes −2 accuracy; ordinary half cover −4; total cover blocks the trajectory. Decide from the actual angle and path.

A direct manifestation appears at its target and ignores those intervening projected-cover penalties. It still needs a legitimate sensory location or authored targeting method. A wall does not become permission to locate an unseen foe. A visible head above cover may be reachable by a direct manifestation while the same barrier interferes with a traveling bolt.

SPEND, DEVELOP and MIRROR DELIBERATELY

BU acquires mechanics. Item BU remains separate. Unspent acquisition budget can support a new primitive during play with table agreement; spending it does not undo progression. The DM and players agree rewards and pacing rather than follow a compulsory XP or per-session schedule.

Default progression reference. The literal cumulative table through level 21 includes its bracket spikes already. Do not add them again.

Level	Cumulative BU	Baseline PB	Baseline maximum Vitality
1	25	2	12
2	35	2	24
3	45	2	36
4	55	2	48
5	69	3	65
6	79	3	78
7	89	3	91
8	99	3	104
9	117	4	126
10	127	4	140
11	137	4	154
12	147	4	168
13	169	5	195
14	179	5	210
15	189	5	225
16	199	5	240
17	225	6	272

Level	Cumulative BU	Baseline PB	Baseline maximum Vitality
18	235	6	288
19	245	6	304
20	255	6	320
21	286	7	357

Active PB/Vitality modifiers change derived values. The explicit level-21 BU value is retained as supplied; replacing the table with a simplified +10 formula would lose its adjustment.

Mirroring reverses a compatible rule within its actual scope: add/subtract, min/max, multiply/divide and grant/revoke have supported opposites. A Set To rule has no automatic opposite. Accepted personal drawbacks still apply when a mirrored ingredient supplies credit; a descriptive reversal must also make sense.

Default debt ceiling: $4 \times \text{ceil}(\text{level} / 4)$: 4 BU at levels 1–4, 8 at 5–8, 12 at 9–12 and so on. Ordinary unspent budget, available mirror credit and actual debt used are different figures. A ceiling is not a mandatory drawback purchase or automatic extra encounter budget. Review eligibility, acquisitions and the drawback's scope before applying credit.

Creation fills ordinary budget first, then eligible drawback credit, then any remaining overflow. Going beyond ordinary allowance requires DM agreement; creation cannot exceed the next-level ceiling or permitted drawback debt. The digital sheet's later warnings do not substitute for that agreement.

THE PRIMITIVE REFERENCE

This is the base construction language, not a catalogue of finished powers. A family describes a kind of rule; a tier describes a family-specific permission. Write the bound subject, recipients, conditions and limits of the actual primitive you acquire. You do not gain all the examples in a family by owning its name.

Default reference. The prices below are suggested acquisition anchors. Authors may propose other prices; the table can accept or revise them. Scaling an eligible use and acquiring new behavior are different decisions. A bigger payment does not supply missing access.

THREE ACCESS FAMILIES

Tier	Verb: what changes	Domain: what the change concerns	Structure: how it is arranged	BU
I	Direct physical or perceptual interaction; simple creation, destruction or force within the permission	Observable subjects: water, fire, air, earth, metal, stone and similar grounded domains	Direct application to self, touch, one point or one target	4
II	Change existing states or properties: reshape, redirect, combine, separate, transfer or stabilize	Physical and conceptual systems: life, growth, memory, emotion and bounded local space or time	Basic spatial or multi-target arrangements: small groups, lines, cones, radii or fields	8
III	Reconfigure internal systems, impose constraints or redirect bounded causal chains	Abstract and systemic subjects: consciousness, identity, information, symbolic systems or bounded causality	Adaptive arrangements: moving zones, branching chains, expansion or conditional patterns	12
IV	Alter governing logic or fundamental constraints within an agreed scope	Fundamental subjects: existence, reality, global causality or foundational laws	Systemic arrangements: scene-wide rules, priority, state-driven inclusion or exclusion	16

These are separate purchases. Verb II is not Domain II. Domain access must identify its subject: Water I permits working with grounded water; it does not grant every Tier I domain. A higher tier describes broader kinds of change, not automatic omniscience, infinite output or success. Read the actual rule when tiers overlap a particular idea.

REACH AND OUTPUT

Range permission	Reach	BU
Touch	Self, contact or ordinary melee reach where appropriate	0
Near	Up to 30 ft	4
Far	Up to 60 ft	8
Very Far	Up to 120 ft	12
Extreme	Continuous reach beyond Very Far, up to approximately 3 miles	24

Extreme has no inaccessible gap at 121–239 ft. Its upper scope can extend by DM agreement. Range never supplies knowledge of a target: locate a specific target through an applicable sense, or use a genuinely authored alternative targeting method.

Output die permission	BU
d4 baseline	0
d6	2
d8	4
d10	8
d12	16
d20	32

An output permission establishes a die type for an appropriate damage or healing construction. It is not an automatic attack, heal, number of dice, number of recipients or delivery method. Appraise those details for the actual use. A character without an acquired range or output category uses the Touch and 1d4 baselines.

RESOLUTION AND EXPRESSION FAMILIES

Range Scaling grants the permitted distance. Specify the maximum reach and any boundary or targeting condition. Increasing reach does not remove obstacles, concealment or the need to locate a particular target.

Speed and Quickening changes execution speed or timing. Identify which working can act faster and under what conditions. It does not silently remove a real dependency: an action cannot use a bridge before someone has created it.

Duration and Persistence establishes how long a result remains. Say whether it is instantaneous, has a fixed duration, follows an ending event or needs continuation. Duration alone grants neither automatic upkeep nor immunity to interference.

Semantic State Tags establishes a named state or qualifying property. Define what the state changes, who qualifies and how it ends. “Invisible,” “frozen” or “blessed” is not a complete rule by itself; it imports no package from another game.

Targeting Arrays and Dimensional Sizing establishes eligible arrangements, selectivity and spatial relationships. Define who can be included or excluded, the shape or target rule and relevant limits. Proposed actual area and recipients still enter appraisal; a field is not automatically harmless to allies.

Intensity and Damage Dice establishes output dice or numerical intensity. Specify damage/healing behavior, source and domain where relevant. Increasing dice count expresses scale; it does not automatically add an unrelated behavior or permission.

CHARACTER FOUNDATION FAMILIES

Vitality Extension changes maximum Vitality or another explicit Vitality rule. Record the operation and scope. Maximum Vitality and current Vitality are separate: increasing the maximum does not itself heal the difference.

Practice and Character Core Progression establishes attribute increases, training, expertise, PB or related core contributions. A named practice's proficiency adds PB where applicable; expertise uses twice PB if granted. Repeating the same training grant does not repeatedly add PB. Current base attribute contributes in full to each of its practices.

Reference primitive	Actual rule	BU
Attribute Increment	Add +I to a chosen attribute, subject to its agreed tier or authored limits	12
Practice Proficiency	Grant proficiency in one named practice	4
Defensive Save Upgrade	Apply PB training to the selected saving-throw scope	4

Universal Mathematical Modifiers applies an operation to an identified quantity. Add, Subtract, Multiply, Divide, Minimum, Maximum, Set To, Grant and Revoke have distinct meanings. Specify whether the target is an attribute, a check, an attack, a save, maximum Vitality, speed or another quantity. A minimum result for one check is not a minimum value for its parent attribute.

Advantage and Probability Bias changes resolution dice or an explicitly named probability rule. Define its scope and stacking. By default, cancel opposing stacks one-for-one; N remaining stacks use N + 1 resolution dice, keeping the highest for advantage or lowest for disadvantage. A static roll bonus is separate.

Perception and Detection Qualifiers establishes what can be noticed or distinguished. Define the subject, conditions and resolution. Detecting a trace of magic does not automatically identify its maker, read their mind or precisely locate them.

Sensory Arrays and Informational Horizons establishes sensory channels and their boundaries: ordinary vision, granted blindsight, tremorsense or another authored sense. Specify reach, obstacles, information and limits. A sense may establish target location without revealing every fact about the target.

Spatial Mobility and Kinematic Locomotion grants a movement mode or changes its speed. Flight permission and flying speed are distinct details: record both. Ordinary swimming and climbing use half walking speed, rounded up; flight and burrowing need suitable access. Track movement across the whole round.

Structural Defenses and Passive Mitigations establishes resistance, vulnerability, immunity or another covered mitigation. State whether it applies to a source, a domain, a condition or a combination. Damage resistance halves matching damage, rounded up. Vulnerability doubles it; immunity negates covered damage. Damage immunity alone does not block every associated condition.

SYSTEM AND REALITY FAMILIES

These families help authors express unusual workings precisely. They are not compulsory extra layers for simple actions. No universal four-tier cost ladder is supplied for every family: record and price the actual permission.

Runtime Trigger Hooks establishes an event that can activate a rule. Define the event, eligible observer/recipient, response and limitations. A trigger does not grant an extra action or Reaction Slot by itself; state how the response uses the action rhythm.

Kinetic and Spatial Control changes force, motion, position or spatial relationships. Define what can move, along what path and against which opposition. Restraining a target, redirecting a projectile and teleporting are different behaviors; their access cannot be inferred from the general family label.

Agency and Information Overrides changes decisions, communication, perception or information. State the actual intrusion, its recipients, resolution and ending conditions. Agree boundaries with the people playing. A suggestion is not automatically unrestricted control, and altered information is not unrestricted knowledge.

Structural Metamorphosis changes form, material or internal organization. Specify what persists, what changes and how the transformation ends. A cosmetic change need not grant another creature's attacks, equipment, defenses or action economy.

Action Economy Alterations changes the available intents, reactions or permitted timing. State the additional opportunity and any restrictions. An action-economy grant is not implied by a grand title, large size or high BU.

Capability Evaluation, Resource Strain, and Dial Management establishes a specific evaluation, resource or scaling rule. Describe what the quantity measures, how it is spent or refreshed and its relationship to a working. BU is acquisition accounting; Cost is execution pressure. Neither is automatically a mana pool or a roll bonus.

Temporal Ordering, Durations, and Stasis changes ordering, time relationships or suspension. Identify whose actions or effects are affected, the permitted interval and the ending terms. Specify how this interacts with Council and the tracks; avoid an undefined instruction to “take another turn.”

Boss Action Economy and Encounter Rhythms supports an explicitly authored creature rhythm. Record extra intents, reactions, triggers or opportunities, and make them legible before they resolve. “Boss” alone grants nothing. The shared rhythm remains Council then Fast then Measured then Heavy unless the table deliberately agrees an exception.

ADDITIONAL FAMILIES

Size Tier and Scale establishes size or an explicit scaling change. Define its actual effects. Size affects baseline movement and carrying capacity, but does not automatically multiply final equipped-slot requirements or grant damage dice.

Sheet Augment changes a specified sheet quantity or available capacity. State the field, operation, scope and limit. A grant of extra equipment slots changes slots; it does not automatically increase carrying capacity or Item BU.

Heritage Augment adds or changes a specific heritage rule, ingredient or limitation. Lineage, Upbringing and Manifest are narrative containers, not a requirement to choose exactly one of each or a universal class progression.

Item Augment adds or changes a stated item permission, modification, capacity or requirement. Specify whether it applies while carried, equipped or actively used. Item mechanics stay in the separate Item BU ledger; a container or item title does not waive Load or slot requirements.

WRITE A PRIMITIVE PEOPLE CAN READ

Use this compact record: **name; readable rule; target/recipient; operation or permission; value/subject; conditions; stacking/uniqueness; ending terms; suggested BU; provenance/version**. Descriptive rules are valid; numerical automation is useful where the behavior is genuinely numerical.

Example: Steady Hands. “Add +2 to Finesse checks to thread or tie a rope while both hands are free.” The recipient is self; the operation is Add; the value is 2; the check and condition are explicit. It does not improve every Physical action. An author might propose 4 BU; that example price requires table agreement, rather than becoming a new canonical tariff.

Test a normal use, an ambitious use and a use outside the scope. For Steady Hands: securing a quiet mooring qualifies; tying a rope in a storm qualifies but the storm still matters; lifting a gate does not qualify. An understandable limit makes both play and review easier.

Worked records and table references

The following constructions reproduce their ingredients so they can be used without a live catalogue. They are examples, not additional mandatory character choices. Acquisition costs use the reference anchors; execution stakes remain contextual.

Mira: a complete starting character

Concept. Mira grew up repairing canal boats. She wants to reopen the abandoned trade route and discover why the river no longer follows its old course. She knows the work of water better than court etiquette and needs companions who can help her reach the old locks.

Field	Starting record
Foundation	Level I; 25 character BU; Medium size
Base attributes	Physical 3, Mental 3, Magical 4: total 10
Proficient attribute	Magical; baseline PB 2
Extra training	Knowledge proficiency
Vitality	Maximum 12; current 12
Short-rest allowance	6 remaining until a completed long rest refreshes it
DC	$5 + 2 + 4 = 11$, using Magical
Movement	Walking 30 ft per round; ordinary swim/climb 15 ft
Equipment	Six equipped slots; capacity $40 + 5 \times 3 = 55$ Load
Acquisition	24 spent; 1 unspent; no mirrored credit

Her practices use the full parent attribute. Prowess, Finesse and Fieldcraft are +3; Awareness, Reason and Influence +3; Knowledge +5; Mysticism, Communion and Intuition +6. Those are combined check bonuses, not numbers to which the same attribute and PB are added again. Saving throws are separate: +3 Physical, +3 Mental and +6 Magical. The chosen proficient Magical attribute supplies PB to its saving throw as well as its practices; further grants and direct modifiers follow their actual scope.

Acquired primitive	Bound definition	BU
Verb Access II	Permission to change existing states/properties within owned domain access: reshape, redirect, combine, separate, transfer or stabilize	8
Water Domain I	Grounded water is an eligible subject; no permission to control every grounded domain or abstract meaning of water	4
Near Range	Permit eligible workings up to 30 ft; use actual target location and path	4
d8 Output	Permit d8 output in an appropriate damage/healing construction; no automatic number of dice or new behavior	4
Knowledge Proficiency	Add PB to applicable Knowledge checks where that training is not already supplied	4

River Caravan Upbringing organizes Verb II, Water I and Knowledge proficiency: 16 BU of the existing ledger. It describes canal work, communal repairs and the habit of asking where a current will go. It does not add a second charge for those acquisitions.

Guided Water, an effect. References Verb II, Water I and Near Range. It permits guiding or reshaping existing grounded water that Mira can locate within 30 ft. Define the actual volume, route and opposition for the attempted use. It supplies neither an invisible-target lock nor unconditional control of every flow.

River Hand, a capability. Uses Guided Water to redirect streams or transfer water between vessels. Ordinary small tasks can need no roll or meaningful Cost. A surging canal may require resolution, more time, help or agreed consequences. Duration and upkeep are agreed for the actual working. The d8 acquisition can support a separately defined water impact; River Hand's description alone is not a healing power.

Sample use. Mira diverts a narrow stream from a worker's legs. The table agrees that reshaping the existing water is within access; the worker is visible and 20 ft away. They choose a Magical check under current conditions, DC 12, before commitment. With Magical proficiency her combined bonus is +6. A roll of 7 gives 13. The diversion succeeds with the pre-agreed restriction: she keeps directing this channel until the worker crosses. There is no second purchase of Water I and no automatic d8 damage.

A COMPLETE ORDINARY ITEM

Canal hook. A Medium two-handed pole with a hook used to draw a rope closer or brace a light object. It has no extraordinary ingredient: Item BU 0, Load 2, final equipped requirement 2 slots. A carried spare still adds Load but uses no equipped slot. Its length gives no automatic Near Range permission for extraordinary workings.

Mira can carry and equip one hook: 2 of 55 Load and 2 of 6 equipped slots. Two hooks contribute 4 Load; equipping both requires 4 slots. Ordinary price and availability are setting decisions, not BU. A backpack organizes them without increasing capacity by default.

Example authored augmentation. “While this hook is equipped and braced on a stable support, add +2 to Prowess checks to hold a gate open.” Record a proposed Item BU price, such as 4, for review. The condition and check are exact; it neither increases Physical nor helps every attack. The hook’s two slots and Load 2 remain unless another explicit rule changes them. The augmented hook is a different item record, not a free benefit in the ordinary hook above.

Read a creature: canal watcher

Purpose. A river spirit guards a spawning bed beside a damaged sluice. It wants a safe flow, not slaughter. It warns anyone disturbing the gate and can negotiate if someone demonstrates a workable diversion.

Field	Complete example record
Chosen creature budget	25 BU; 20 acquired/spent; 5 remaining; no mirror credit
Foundation	Rank I; attribute points 3; Physical 2, Mental 0, Magical 1
Training	Proficient Magical; PB 2
Practices	Prowess/Finesse/Fieldcraft +2; Awareness/Reason/Knowledge/Influence +0; Mysticism/Communion/Intuition +3
Save bonuses	Physical +2; Mental +0; Magical +3 from the proficient attribute; no extra save-training grant
DC	5 + PB 2 + chosen Magical 1 = 8
Vitality	Maximum/current 13/13; unused short-rest allowance 7 if agreed rests apply
Size and mobility	Small; walking 25 ft; ordinary swim/climb 13 ft
Senses	Ordinary sight and hearing; no granted sense through walls
Items	None: Item BU 0; six equipment slots; carrying capacity 20 + 5 × 2 = 30

The baseline follows $r = \sqrt{25/25} = 1$; attribute points $\text{ceil}(3r) = 3$; PB $1 + \text{ceil}(r) = 2$; Vitality $\text{ceil}(25/2) = 13$. It uses the same fully stated Verb II, Water I, Near Range and d8 definitions as Mira, totaling 20 BU. It has no Knowledge proficiency purchase.

Turn the Current. A capability referencing Guided Water’s Verb II, Water I and Near Range ingredients. Redirect or reshape existing located water within 30 ft. State the actual path, volume, recipients and opposition before resolving. This does not automatically move a creature against its will; contest or another agreed resolution can be needed.

Water Impact. Uses those ingredients and d8 output to drive existing water into one located target within 30 ft. **Example normal expression:** 1d8 Magical Water damage, projected through the actual path. At

this table it uses an attack check with Magical training, +3, against the target's DC; it does not also demand a save by default. Appraise changed volume, recipients, timing or effort separately. This sample expression grants no healing, resistance or extra actions.

Behavior and tells. The Watcher points toward the spawning bed before attacking. It prefers turning the current to injuring people. It retreats or talks when the threat to the bed ends. A dry bank deprives it of useful existing water; its unused BU does not grant water creation, armor or teleportation.

In the digital creature editor, practice-allocation slices may be recorded as Physical Prowess 2/Finesse 0/Fieldcraft 0; Magical Mysticism 1/Communion 0/Intuition 0; Mental all 0. Those allocations satisfy its base ledger; the displayed checks still use the relevant full current attribute and applicable training, as listed above.

PROGRESS BEYOND LEVEL 21

Progression does not stop at level 20. Retain the published cumulative threshold at level 21, 286 BU. After that, add 10 each level and the subsequent four-level bracket spikes: +24 at level 25, +28 at 29, +32 at 33, continuing in that pattern. These are additions to the ordinary +10 at those levels. PB still follows $2 + \text{floor}((\text{level} - 1)/4)$.

Level	Cumulative BU	Baseline PB	Baseline maximum Vitality
22	296	7	374
23	306	7	391
24	316	7	408
25	350	8	450
26	360	8	468
29	418	9	551

Do not add a spike again to an already cumulative table value. Active PB and Vitality modifiers can change the resolved sheet.

MIRROR CREDIT WITHOUT ERASING THE DRAWBACK

Example, not a mandatory build. A level 1 character has 25 BU and spends 27 on positive acquisitions. An accepted eligible personal drawback supplies 2 credit, giving 25 net spent and 2 actual used debt. The level 1 debt ceiling is 4. The positive build is also below the next-level creation ceiling of 35. Review the drawback's actual rule and obtain the DM's agreement to exceed the ordinary allowance.

Having a ceiling of 4 does not mean the character automatically receives 4 credit. A character spending 23 has 2 ordinary BU remaining, even if the sheet also shows potential mirror headroom. A character proposing 31 positive

BU with only 2 valid credit remains 29 net spent: another 4 is not covered merely because a ceiling exists. Overflow still needs explicit agreement and must respect both applicable limits.

Compatible pairs are Add/Subtract, Multiply/Divide, Minimum/Maximum and Grant/Revoke. Set To has no automatic opposite. A personal drawback that revokes flight remains on that person; separately proposing flight for an ally does not repay or suppress it. A narrow condition or non-mirrorable rule must be respected.

AT THE TABLE: A QUICK REFERENCE

1. State an intent. Confirm ordinary circumstances and extraordinary access.
2. Locate the target or establish an authored alternative. Declare actual reach, recipients, output and duration.
3. Agree uncertainty, stakes, Cost and its timing. Revise the attempt if needed.
4. Resolve the chosen check, contest, clash, attack or save; apply bias and modifiers once.
5. Record changed positions, current Vitality, movement used, reactions, consequences and ongoing requirements.

Remember	Default or procedure
A check	d20 + current attribute + applicable training + modifiers
Trained / expert	PB / twice PB where actually granted
Bias	Cancel opposing stacks; N net stacks means N + 1 dice, keep appropriate extreme
Shared round	Council then Fast (0-1) then Measured (2-3) then Heavy (4+)
Reaction	One independent slot per round; valid trigger, immediate Complexity 0-1, self/touch or one target
Movement	One round allowance; split among tracks/reactions as the situation permits
Continuing work	One upkeep track per maintained capability; requirements of several capabilities accumulate
Damage defenses	Matching resistance half rounded up; vulnerability double; immunity zero
Collapse	Rescue promptly; stabilization stops dying but does not heal or wake
Short rest	Finite allowance $\text{ceil}(\text{max Vitality}/2)$; consume actual healing, carry unused recovery
Long rest	Agreed overnight recovery; normally full healing, refresh short-rest allowance
Purchases	Count acquisitions once; character BU, Item BU and execution Cost remain separate

GLOSSARY

Acquisition: an owned occurrence of a primitive, recorded in its ledger. References to it in several compositions are not extra purchases.

Attribute: Physical, Mental or Magical; use its current numerical value directly.

BU, Build Units: the acquisition measure. It is not automatically money, a spell resource or an encounter difficulty rating.

Capability: a working or talent organized from actual primitives, effects and readable rules.

Clash: a timing resolution when opposing intents meet; distinct from a contest of effort.

Complexity: the dependencies of an action, used in placing it in the shared rhythm; distinct from power or Strain.

Consequence: an actual change with a cause, applicable timing and ending/recovery terms.

Cost: the agreed pressure or consequence of an attempted execution; may be mechanical, restrictive, environmental or narrative.

Council: the coordination/continuation point at the beginning of a shared round.

DC: a difficulty target; a character's selected-attribute DC is distinct from their three saving throws.

Domain: the subject that an extraordinary permission can affect.

Effect: a reusable grouping of ingredients or outcomes; it is not an automatic new purchase.

Heritage: Lineage, Upbringing or Manifest: a narrative organization of actual acquired content.

Intent: the outcome an actor wants, stated before the resolution procedure is chosen.

Item BU: the separate acquisition accounting for equipment mechanics.

Load: carried burden; distinct from equipped slots, Item BU and ordinary value.

Mirror: an eligible reversed rule with actual scope and an accepted drawback; not an unrestricted cancellation trick.

PB: proficiency bonus. Apply applicable training once; expertise uses twice PB when granted.

Practice: an approach to a check associated with an attribute; ordinary attempts do not require training.

Primitive: a reusable permission or rule, with its own recipients, conditions and accounting.

Reaction: an immediate eligible response through an available independent slot and actual trigger.

Strain: contextual appraisal of how an attempt pushes the actor and situation, graded 0–6 as guidance.

Structure: the permitted arrangement of a working; it supplies no unrelated domain or verb access.

Template / play copy: a reusable creature definition / one independent creature's state in play.

Track: Fast, Measured or Heavy resolution timing in a shared round.

Upkeep: an agreed ongoing requirement of a maintained working; not necessarily damage.

Verb: the kind of change an extraordinary permission allows.

Vitality: current capacity to remain in action; its maximum and current value are separate.

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Alpha status. This is a complete alpha publication, open to corrections and table feedback. One specific rule remains undecided: additional Vitality upkeep payments triggered by incoming damage, including its threshold and counter handling. It is visibly marked in the upkeep section. Other agreed upkeep requirements remain usable; this edition does not impose that unsettled numerical scheme.

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